

Workshop



ACADEMIC SKILLS



MS Word

For Formatting Assignments

Education Services

academicskills@rcl.ac.uk



Session objectives

Today we will:

- ❖ Learn basic commands to format a document
- ❖ Practise using these commands

How to get started



1. Open the Word app.
2. Choose the document you want to format.



Meetings 4_Brainstorming and evaluating_text

Tatiana Romeiro's OneDrive - RTC Education Ltd » Documents » ASK » Ask Activities on SCOPE » Lets talk business - B2



Just now

3. Double click to open it.

Basic Commands

Selecting / Undo (...)



Selecting text

- ❖ **Single-click** to move the cursor to the area you want it to be in.
- ❖ **Double-click** to select a word.
 - ❖ Word will select to the left and right of the cursor, until it encounters a space character.
- ❖ **Triple-click** to select the current paragraph.
- ❖ **Margin + click** to select an entire line
 - ❖ Move the cursor into the left margin. When you see the insertion pointer turn into an arrow pointer, click. Doing so will select the current line.
- ❖ **CTRL+A** to select the whole text
 - ❖ Press **CTRL** and **A** at the same.

Undo / Re-do

❖ To undo an action.

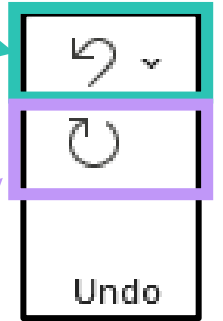
Click **Undo** on the Quick Access Toolbar.

You can click Undo (or press both **CTRL** and **Z**) repeatedly if you want to undo multiple steps.

❖ To redo something, you've undone

Click **Re-do** on the Quick Access toolbar.

(The **Re-do** button only appears after you've undone an action.)



*******IMPORTANT*******

Once you save and exit you can no longer use these functions.

Formatting a text

Analysing a sample



INTRODUCTION

Whatever stage you are at in your academic life, you will have to review the literature and write about it. You will be asked to do this as a student when you write essays, dissertations and theses. Later, whenever you write an academic paper, there will usually be some element of literature review in the introduction. And if you have to write a grant application, you will be expected to review the work that has already been done in your area. However, just because we all have to do this a lot, doesn't make the task any easier, and indeed for many, writing a literature review is one of the most challenging aspects of their academic writing. In this study guide, I will begin by clearing up some misconceptions about what a literature review is and what it is not. Then, I will break the process down into a series of simple steps, looking at examples along the way. In the end, I hope you will have a simple, practical strategy to write an effective literature review. However, before we get going, I need to manage your expectations. Some people come to a study guide like this thinking that it will help them understand the literature they are reading in their own field. I can't do that for you. I can only help you write about the understanding you already possess. You have to put the necessary work in to develop your own critical skills which often have to be honed over a long period through reading, attending lectures, seminars and conferences and discussing your own work and that of others with your peers. That is how you build your scholarship. What this guide is about is doing justice to that scholarship and making sure your readers are left in no doubt about your ability to critically evaluate the published literature.

WHAT IS A LITERATURE REVIEW?

This might seem like a very simple question. Of course, you know what a literature review is. Everyone knows what they are and what they look like. Well, if that's true why are they so often badly written, difficult to read and lacking in any meaningful critical evaluation of the papers and

Sample

Take a look at the sample document and consider the following:

- ❖ Layout
- ❖ Fonts
- ❖ Paragraphs
- ❖ Space between lines.

Writing an Effective Literature Review A Study Guide INTRODUCTION

Whatever stage you are at in your academic life, you will have to review the literature and write about it. You will be asked to do this as a student when you write essays, dissertations and theses. Later, whenever you write an academic paper, there will usually be some element of literature review in the introduction. **And if you have to write a grant application, you will be expected to review the work that has already been done in your area.** However, just because we all have to do this a lot, doesn't make the task any easier, and indeed for many, writing a literature review is one of the most challenging aspects of their academic writing. In this study guide, I will begin by clearing up some misconceptions about what a literature review is and what it is not. Then, I will break the process down into a series of simple steps, looking at examples along the way. In the end, I hope you will have a simple, practical strategy to write an effective literature review.

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This is a font type and colour that is not acceptable for assignments/presentations

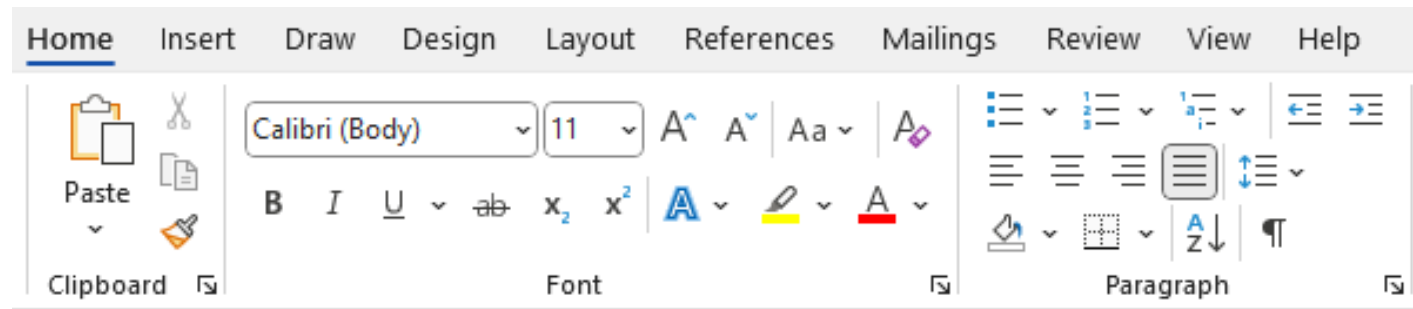
This section has 3 different font styles.

- Difficult to visualise paragraphs.
- Space between lines also makes it hard to read.

'Home tab'

This is where you find the essentials to format your text.

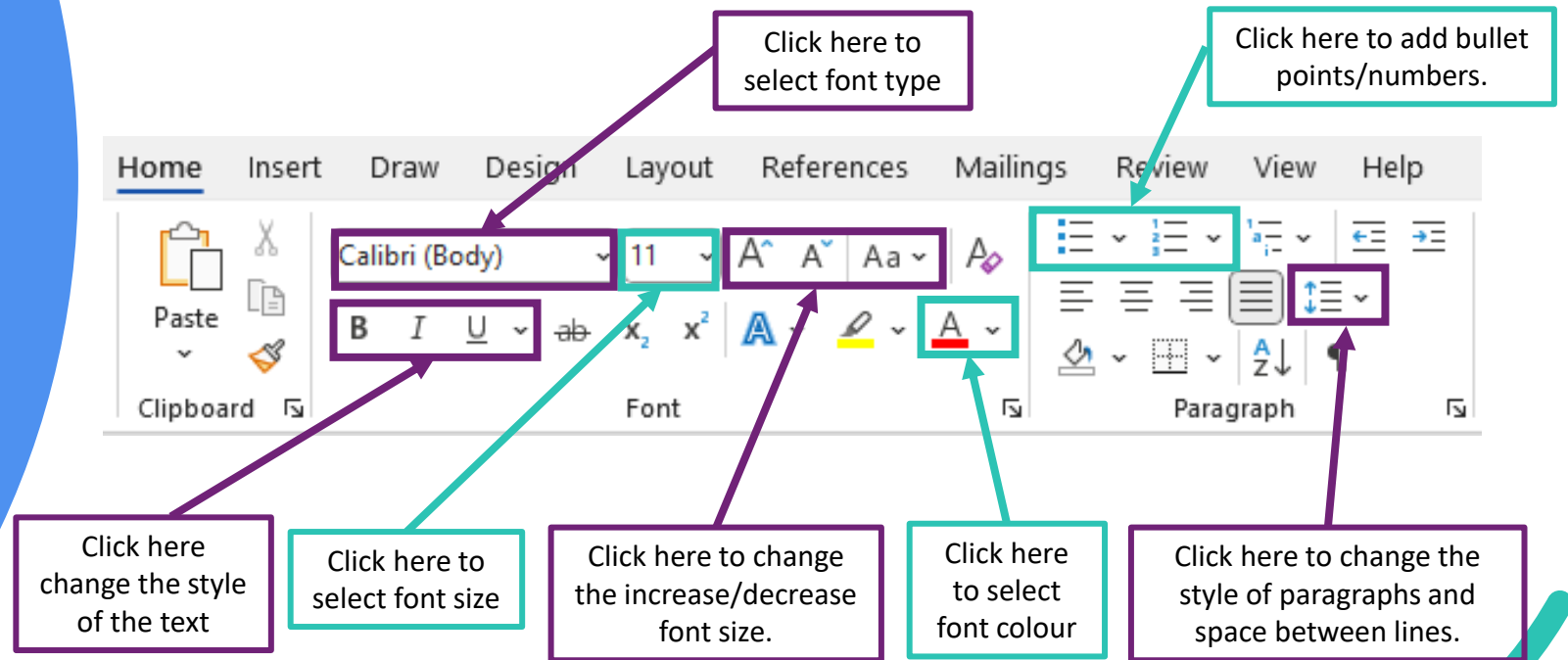
- ❖ Read your brief/guidelines carefully before submitting – it may require specific formatting style.
- ❖ Press both **CTRL** and **A** to select all text.
- ❖ For this we are using font:
 - ❖ **Calibri (Body)**

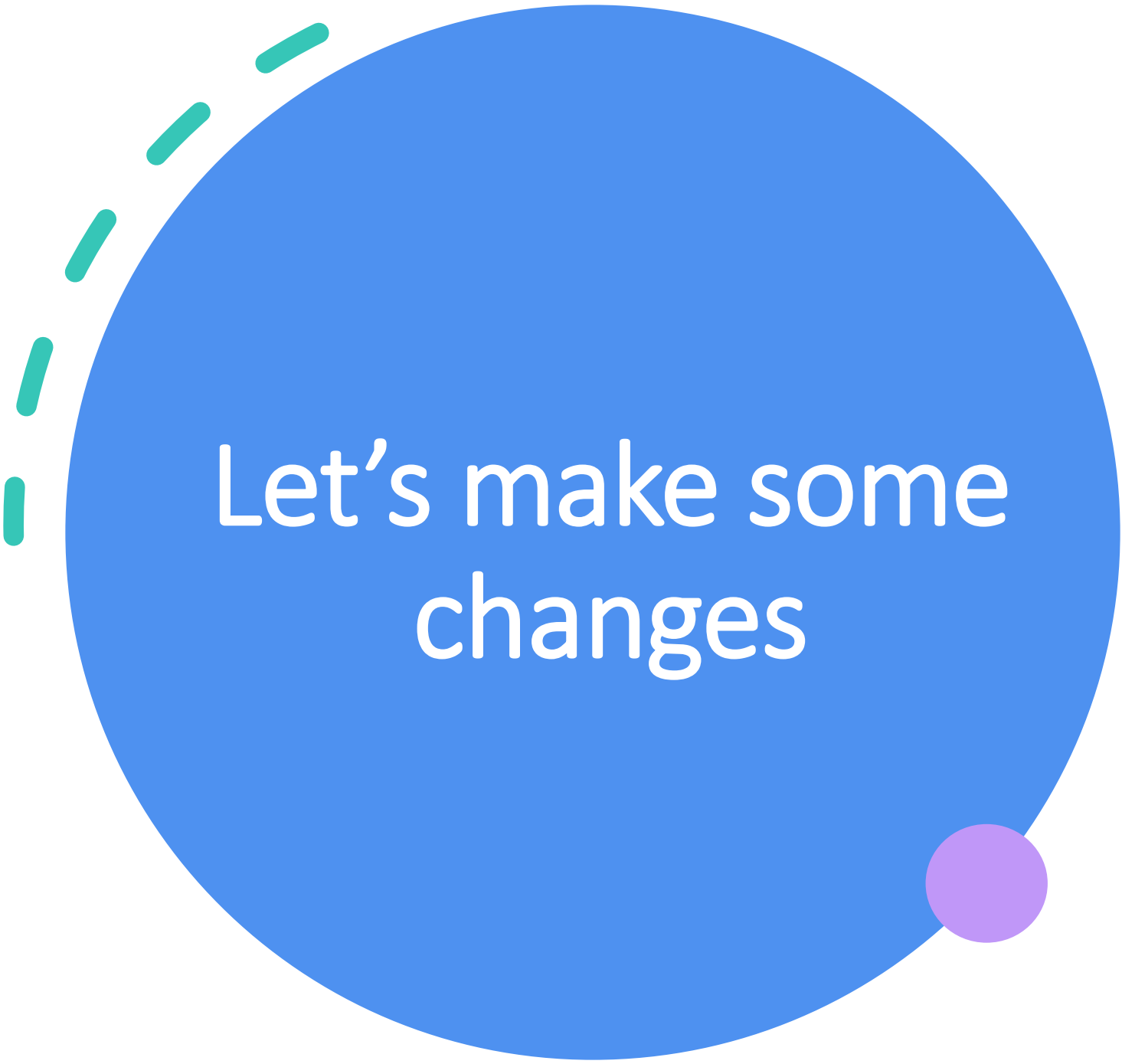


'Home tab'

There you can change:

- ❖ Font type, size, colour and style.
- ❖ Paragraph style and space between lines.
- ❖ Add bullets/numbers (lists)





Let's make some
changes

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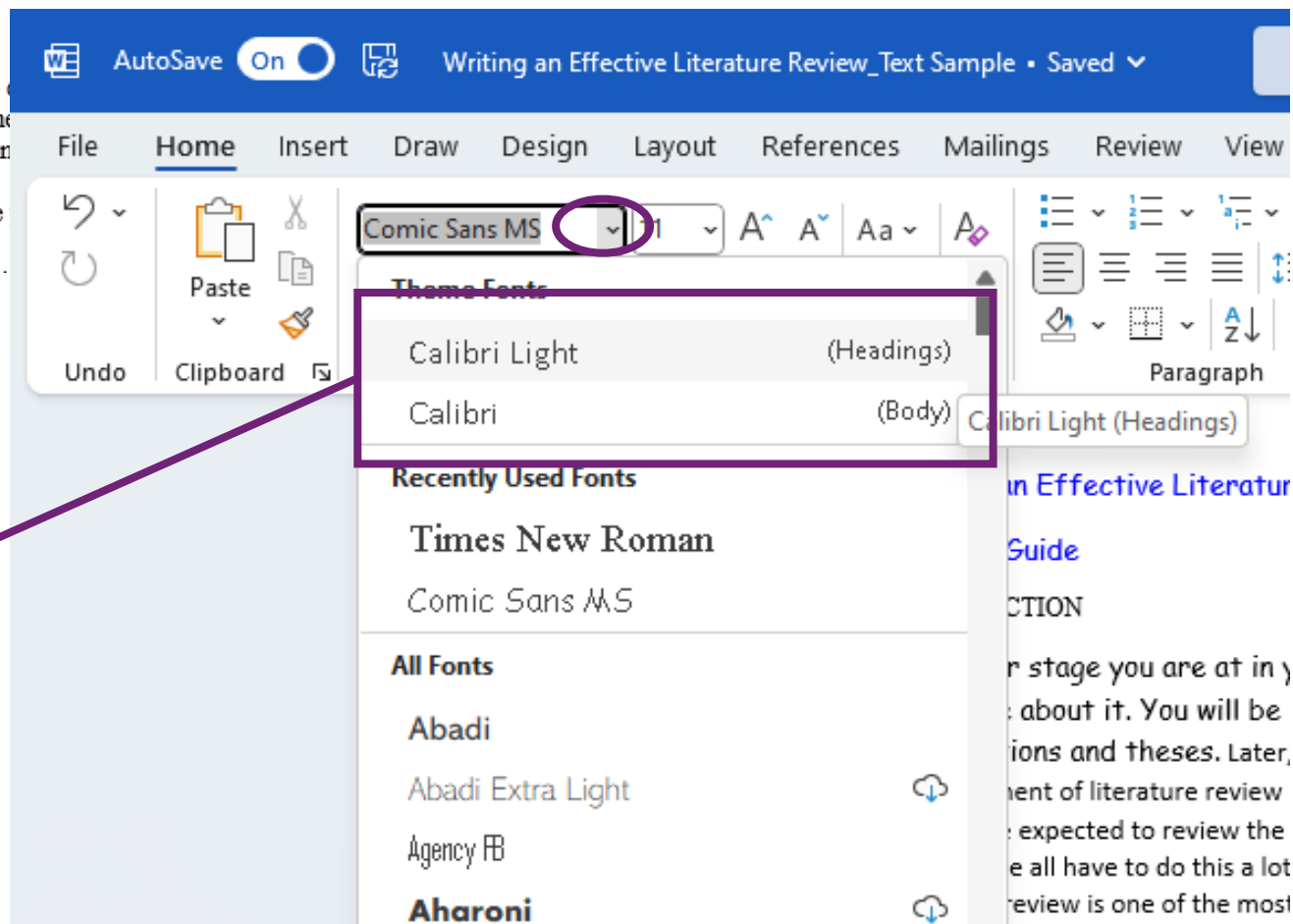
Select the text/section and change the font type by clicking on the arrow to open the options

Choose the font

Here we are using:

Calibri Light – headings and subheadings

Calibri - body



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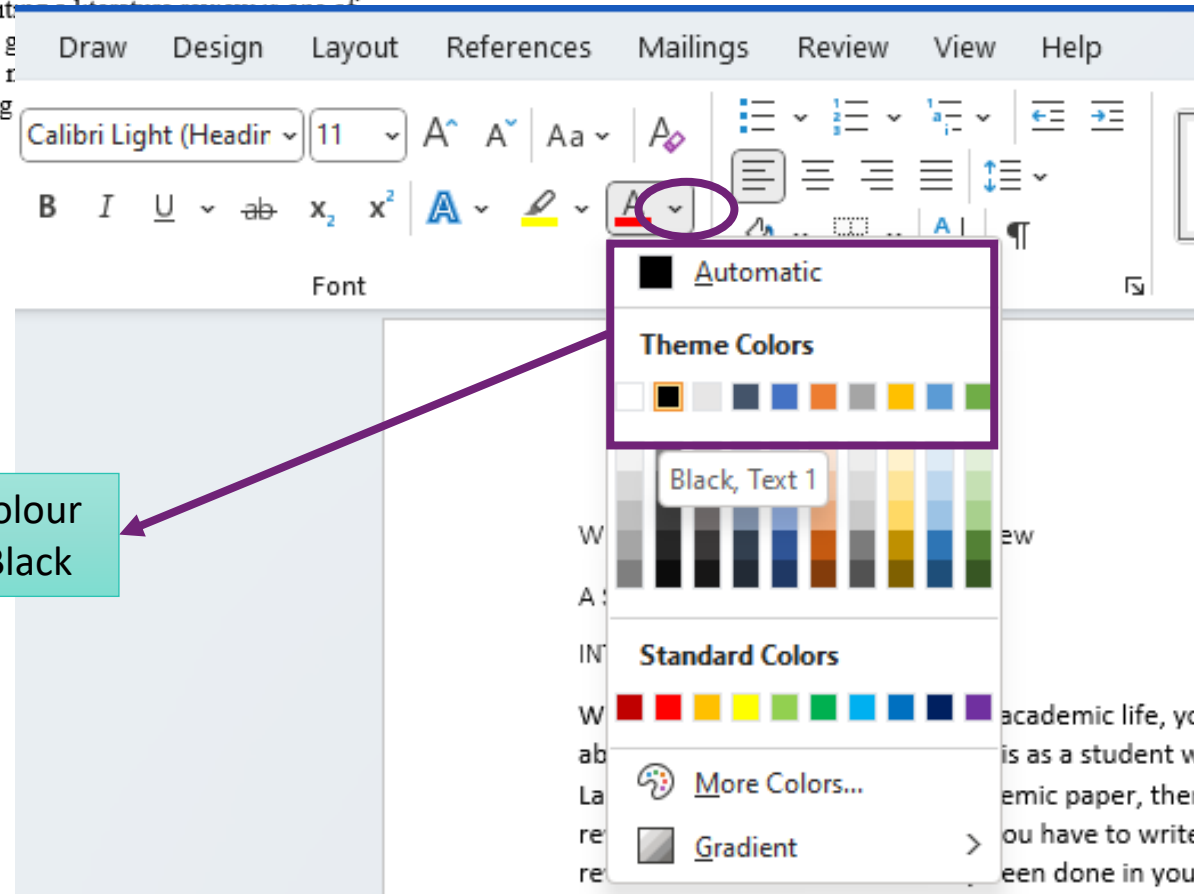
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This is how it
looks like
using all the
same font.

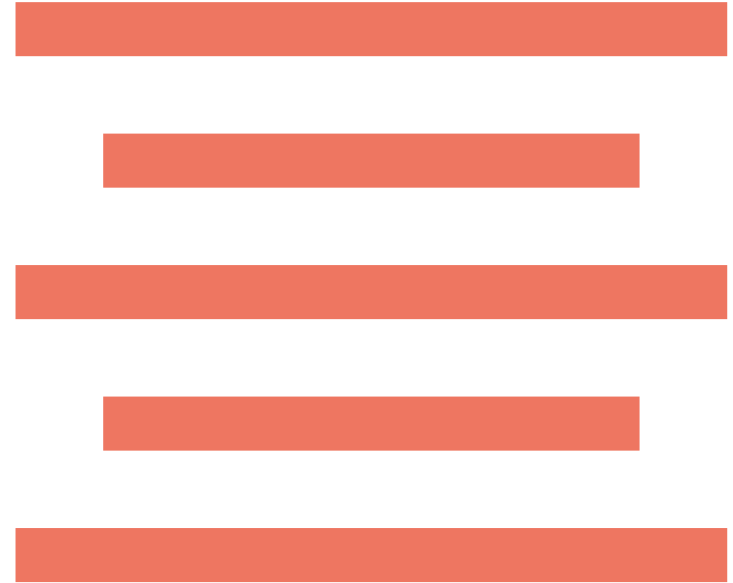
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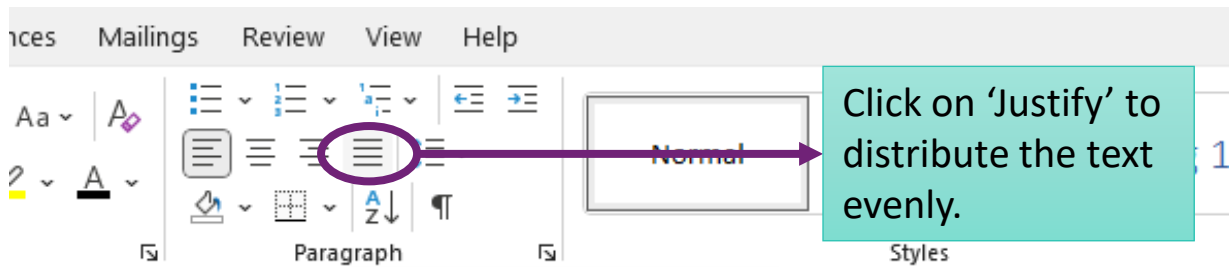
Select the text/section and change the colour by clicking on the arrow to open the options.



Choose the colour
Automatic / Black

Paragraph Formatting





Click on 'Justify' to distribute the text evenly.

Justify (Ctrl+J)
Distribute your text evenly between the margins.

Justified text gives your document clean, crisp edges so it looks more polished.

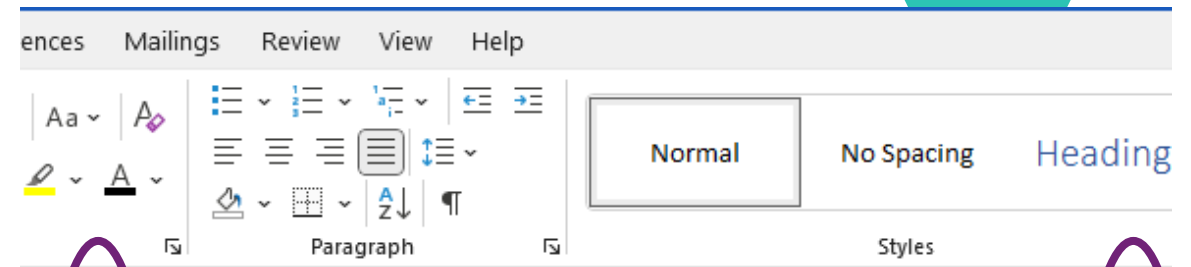
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A literature review is a survey of published work relevant to a particular issue, field of research, topic or theory. It will never be about everything and should have clearly defined limits. This survey will

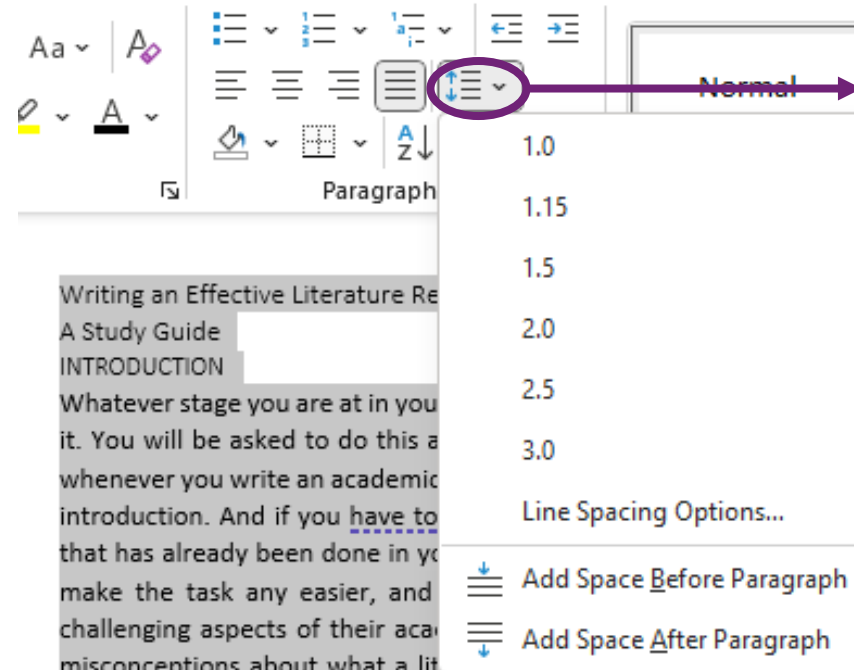


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Click on 'Line and Paragraph Spacing' to format the document.

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Whatever stage you are at in your writing, you will be asked to do this a lot. You will be asked to do this a lot whenever you write an academic introduction. And if you have to do this a lot, that has already been done in your writing. It makes the task any easier, and it is a challenging aspects of their academic writing. It is a misconception about what a literature review is.

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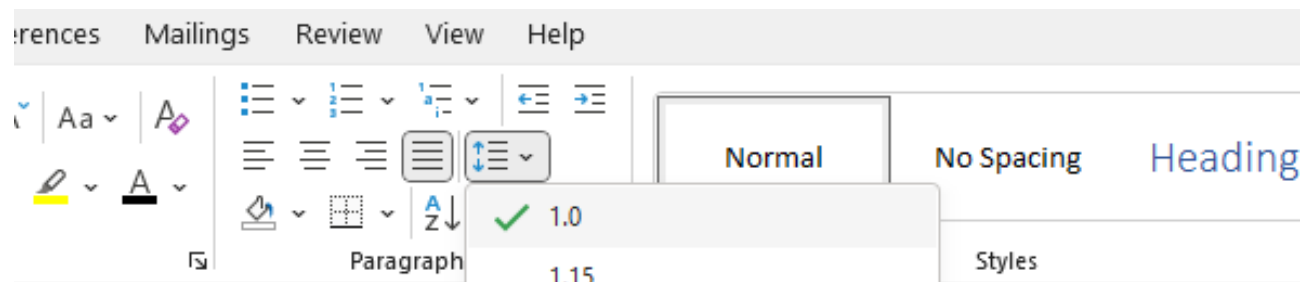
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Choose how much space between lines you want.
Double check your guidelines to follow the specifications.

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Adding Bullet Points / Numbers



References Mailings Review View Help

Click on 'Bullet Library' to add bullets to the selected section.

Bullet Library

None • ○ ■ ■ ■

Document Bullets

• -

Change List Level

Define New Bullet...

Given the m... e writing a literature review in
academia, at... review is not, before looking at
what it is.
It is not:
A list or ann...
A simple summary of those sources or paraphrasing of the conclusions.
Confined to description of the studies and their findings.
Narrow and shallow in its approach.
Confusing and longwinded in the way you write about the papers.
Constructed in an arbitrary fashion.

It is: § A critical evaluation of the literature you have read § A synthesis of the available research in a
defined area § Broad and deep in its approach § Clear and concise in the way you write about the

References Mailings Review View Help

Choose the design.

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None • ○ ■ ■ ■

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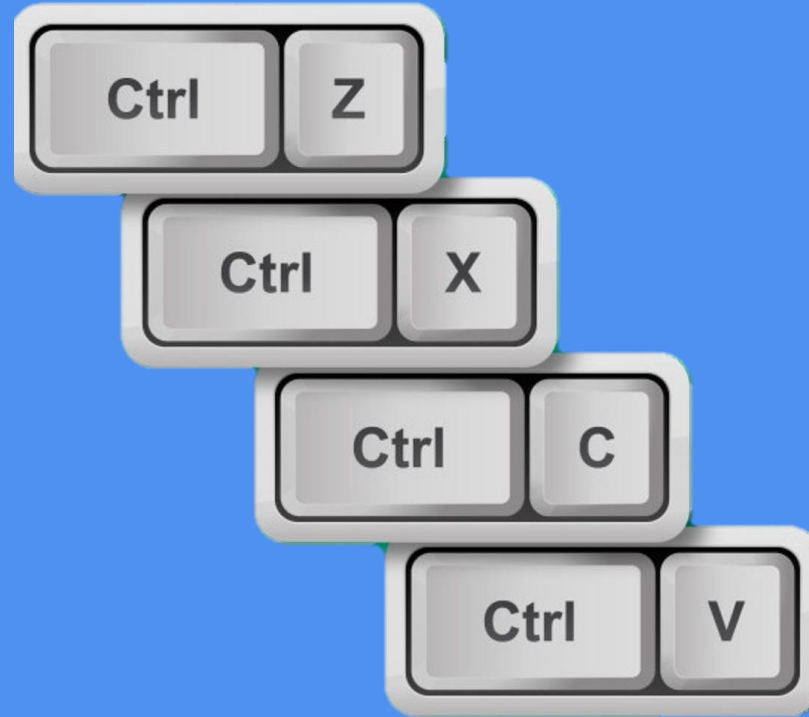
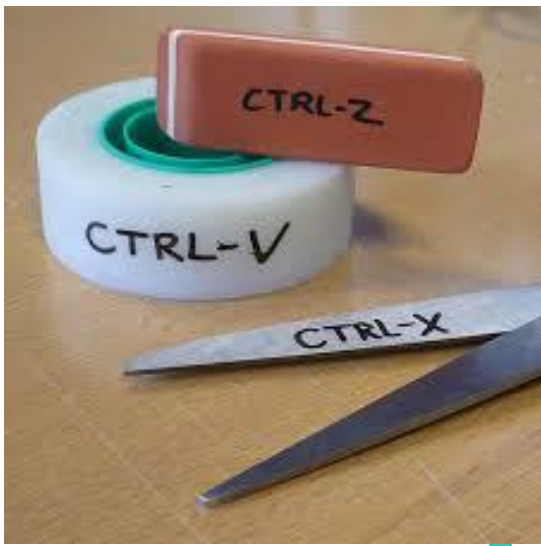
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papers § Guided by a clearly defined, consistent concept.



The mighty CTRL + ...

Undo

Use these commands to undo your last action.

❖ You can use the keyboard:

ctrl

+

z

❖ You can use the button on the 'Home Tab'



Copy & Paste

Using the keyboard

Use these commands to easily copy a section and copy it in a different place.

❖ You can use the keyboard.

❖ Hold **ctrl** + **C** to copy.

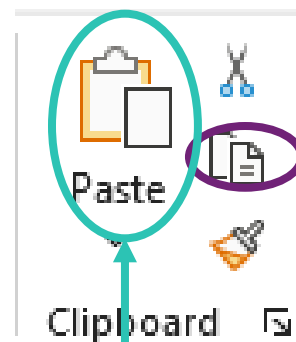
❖ Choose where you want to paste it.

❖ Hold **ctrl** + **V** to paste it.

Copy & Paste Using the 'Home Tab'

Use these commands to easily copy a section and copy it in a different place.

❖ Select the word/section.



❖ Click to copy.

❖ Choose the place.

❖ Click to paste.

Cut & Paste

Using the keyboard

Use these commands to easily copy a section and paste it in a different place.

❖ You can use the keyboard.

❖ Hold **ctrl** + **X** to cut it.

❖ Choose where you want to paste it.

❖ Hold **ctrl** + **V** to paste it.



Thank you.

For more support
and guidance, contact us on:
academicskills@rcl.ac.uk

